

LLOYD A. WRIGHT, MBA

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Leadership | Entrepreneurship Education | Strategic Partnerships | Venture Capital

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Serial entrepreneur, university program director, and community leader with more than 30 years of experience at the intersection of entrepreneurship, academic leadership, and economic development. Proven record of building and managing university-based entrepreneurship and small business programs at both the University of Houston and Prairie View A&M University. Secured over \$20 million in venture capital and private equity funding across multiple industries. Deeply committed to developing the whole entrepreneur — combining rigorous execution with values-driven mentorship — and to expanding access to entrepreneurship education for underserved communities.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Community Outreach Director

2025 – Present

Office of Texas State Senator Borris Miles | Houston, TX

Serve as the primary liaison between Senator Miles's office and the constituents, businesses, and institutions within the district, which includes the University of Houston. Coordinate economic development initiatives, connect community organizations to public and private resources, and represent the Senator's office at civic and business events throughout the Houston region.

- Build and sustain relationships with local business leaders, civic organizations, university administrators, and government stakeholders to advance economic development goals.
- Serve as a key resource connecting small businesses and entrepreneurs to government programs, funding sources, and contracting opportunities.
- Deepen institutional knowledge of how universities, government, and the private sector can collaborate to drive innovation and community impact.

Principal

2024 – Present

Longview Meridian & Longview Realty and Development | Houston, TX

Lead strategic initiatives across real estate development, international markets, and economic development projects. Advise and support ventures across multiple industries while continuing to build cross-sector partnerships connecting entrepreneurs to emerging markets and opportunities.

- Direct real estate acquisition, development, and market entry strategy across domestic and international markets.
- Provide ongoing advisory support to investors, developers and entrepreneurs navigating growth, capital formation, and market expansion in real estate market.

Owner

2022 – 2024

TULUM HTX | Houston, TX

- Launched a high-concept Mexican culture and cuisine bar and restaurant in Houston, delivering an immersive dining and entertainment experience. Built team of 18 and drove \$3M in annual revenue. Partnered with local influencers, musicians, and civic leaders to build community engagement and traffic.

Founder & Owner

2020 – 2024

Sin Semilla Health & Wellness (PVR Green de Mexico) | Puerto Vallarta, MX

Established Puerto Vallarta's first licensed health and wellness medical cannabis dispensary following legalization, combining retail operations with community health programming. Led all operations, marketing, partnerships, and community outreach.

- Created and implemented diet and treatment plans for various ailments utilizing locally sourced natural products.

- Provided community health and wellness seminars throughout Puerto Vallarta and Guadalajara.
- Developed successful international market entry strategy; employed local residents and provided skills training to single mothers.
- Generated over \$2 million in revenue within the first two years of operation.

Director

2018 – 2020

Prairie View A&M University Small Business Development Center | Prairie View, TX

Led all daily operations of the SBDC to create measurable economic impact across Grimes and Waller Counties and the University. Served as the senior small business counselor, providing leadership, technical assistance, and quality training to existing business owners and aspiring entrepreneurs throughout Southeast Texas.

- Provided high-quality individual expertise to entrepreneurs, business owners, and business managers on business plans, market feasibility, financial viability, operations management, and legal structures.
- Organized and promoted high-quality business training programs responsive to the needs of the local business community.
- Actively engaged Prairie View A&M students in SBDC training initiatives including market research, business plan development, financial analysis, social media planning, and HR compliance.
- Recruited and retained part-time counselors; maintained an active client referral network.
- Served as a key small business resource for local economic development, civic, government, and business organizations.

Partner / Vice President

2005 – 2018

4W Solutions, Inc. | Houston, TX

Management consulting firm specializing in IT, human capital, and government contracting strategy. Served as principal partner responsible for developing and implementing go-to-market strategies, forming strategic partnerships in private and governmental sectors, and leading all sales, marketing, and public relations activities.

- Secured over \$20 million in venture capital and private equity funding for startups in technology, medical, and energy markets.
- Achieved gross revenues in excess of \$50 million across large and small accounts.
- Developed profitable new product launch strategies for emerging technologies.
- Worked with Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs) to align institutional research with federal contract procurement; helped HBCUs secure contract awards exceeding \$50 million.
- Managed and mentored direct reports; oversaw budget planning and career development for team members.
- Developed strategic commercialization plans for market penetration and maintained high-profile external relationships with professional organizations and corporate constituents.

Adjunct Professor

2014 – 2018

University of Houston | Houston, TX

Teach entrepreneurship, leadership and small business courses to undergraduate students, integrating real-world case studies, experiential learning, and mentorship into course delivery.

Adjunct Professor

2015

Houston Christian University | Houston, TX

Delivered business and entrepreneurship instruction at the undergraduate level.

Business Development Coordinator

2015 – 2016

City of Houston | Houston, TX

Performed contract audits to ensure compliance with prevailing labor wage rates, EEO requirements, and MWSDBE utilization goals. Assisted prime contractors with identifying qualified MWSDBE subcontractors and conducted pre-bid meetings to explain City of Houston compliance policies.

- Collected thousands of dollars in underpayments on behalf of underpaid employees.
- Conducted informational pre-certification workshops and responded to MWSDBE certification inquiries.

Owner / Manager

2010 – 2015

Dbar Lounge (Dowling Street Bar and Lounge) | Houston, TX

Built one of Houston's premier nightlife destinations, expanding to a second location with 30+ employees. Hosted events for over 5,000 attendees including political fundraisers, toy drives, and brand activations. Drove over \$4 million in annual revenue before successfully exiting the business.

Assistant Project Manager

2007 – 2010

Hess Corporation | Houston, TX

Supported project management operations for one of the nation's leading energy companies, contributing to project planning, coordination, and execution within the Building Services division.

Director, Procurement Technical Assistance Center

2003 – 2005

University of Houston Small Business Development Center | Houston, TX

Supervised a Department of Defense-funded center focused on connecting small, minority, and disadvantaged businesses with major corporate, federal, state, and local government contracting opportunities. Managed annual budgets in full compliance with Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR). Coordinated with Texas Manufacturing Extension Partnership (TMAC) and Space Alliance Technology Outreach Program (SATOP).

- Grew program contract awards from \$6 million to over \$20 million through a targeted outreach initiative.
- Developed and conducted client training courses on Federal Acquisition Regulations and government contracting.
- Wrote grant proposals and secured major corporate sponsorships under joint federally funded contractual agreements.
- Made formal program introductions to major corporate donors and sponsors to secure additional funding.
- Participated in the implementation of the Malcolm Baldrige National Quality Award process for performance excellence.
- Established staff work assignments and provided guidance, professional development, and departmental direction.

Owner / Director of Business Development

2001 – 2004

CCMC, Inc. | Houston, TX

Provided business development, marketing, and management services for an architectural, engineering, and construction inspection firm. Wrote responses to RFPs, RFQs, and invitations for bids. Served as Contract Administrator with Harris County and the City of Houston.

- Secured construction and project management contracts in excess of \$11 million.

Manager, Business Development

1998 – 2001

Enron Corporation | Houston, TX

Responsible for writing all Building Services Division responses to RFPs and RFQs. Performed variance analysis between budgeted and actual results for accounting reconciliation. Prepared financial analyses of project costs for executive and stakeholder reporting.

- Generated RFQs and RFPs resulting in contract awards in excess of \$100 million.

- Redesigned sales and marketing collateral following the company's bankruptcy filing.
- Assisted in the transition of over 1,000 employees and 37 contracts through post-bankruptcy restructuring.

Partner / Loan Officer & Contract Administrator

1994 – 1998

Small Business Capital Development Group | Washington, DC

Processed loans for business start-up, working capital, and expansion financing. Served as Loan Administrator for the only SBA-approved Community Development Corporation in the Washington, D.C. metropolitan area.

- Financed over \$25 million in community development loans for small businesses, creating 175 jobs across Washington, DC, Virginia, and Maryland.
- Served as Contract Administrator for the Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority's \$7.5 million small business development program.
- Developed a model to track small and minority business participation goals and contract awards for the Maryland Department of Transportation and WMATA.

EDUCATION

Executive Master of Business Administration (MBA)

Jones Graduate School of Business, Rice University | Houston, TX

Master's Certificate, Minority Business Entrepreneurship

Darden School of Business, University of Virginia | Charlottesville, VA

Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA), International Business Finance

Howard University | Washington, DC

LEADERSHIP, AFFILIATIONS & COMMUNITY SERVICE

- Board of Directors, National Association of Minority Contractors, Washington, DC
- Board of Directors, Career and Recovery Resources, a United Way Agency, Houston, TX
- Board of Directors, Tied To Solutions
- Eagle Scout, Boy Scouts of America
- PhD. Project Participant
- Community collaborator with Houston city officials, state representatives, and civic leaders
- Frequent speaker and presenter on entrepreneurship, small business development, and economic empowerment

CORE COMPETENCIES

Core Competencies: Entrepreneurship Education & Mentorship, Program Direction & Management, Venture Capital & Private Equity, Strategic Planning, Capital Formation, Consultative Sales, Business Development, Contract Negotiation, Grant Proposal Development, Budget Management, Multichannel Marketing, Government Contracting (FAR), Team Leadership, Stakeholder Engagement, Public/Private Partnership Development, Community Outreach, Pitch Deck Development